

ASHIMA SITAULA, PhD

Instructional Designer & Learning Experience Designer | AI Literacy Programs

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Instructional designer and program leader who builds scalable, ready-to-teach programs — curriculum designed to be delivered by other people. 10+ years across K–12, higher education, and community organizations, plus a computing degree, which means designing curriculum and then building it rather than handing off a spec. PhD in Curriculum & Instruction with a research focus on technology integration and learner engagement. Currently reaching ~4,000 learners annually across 10+ distributed sites. Translates complex technical goals into modular learning content — from AI literacy programs and instructor enablement systems to open-source courses built through human-AI collaboration.

EXPERIENCE

Curriculum Manager

Jun 2025 – Present

Code For Fun • Sunnyvale, CA • Promoted from Curriculum Designer (Contract), Dec 2024 – Jun 2025

- Manage the curriculum team — 3 full-time staff plus contractors — and own the curriculum portfolio across all Code For Fun products
- Own several products end-to-end, including Computer Science League — curriculum, instructor training, classroom observation, levelling students correctly, and direct communication with parents
- Lead end-to-end curriculum strategy for CS and STEAM programs reaching ~4,000 learners annually across distributed after-school and camp sites, aligned to CSTA and California K–12 CS Standards
- Design scalable curriculum development processes with structured review cycles, defined success metrics, and rollout frameworks ensuring quality across 10+ sites
- Built instructor enablement and onboarding system supporting 50+ educators per year, increasing implementation fidelity and instructional effectiveness
- Drive continuous improvement through classroom observation, feedback loops, pilot testing, and cross-functional collaboration with operations and marketing

Graduate Research & Teaching Assistant

Aug 2023 – Aug 2024

Indiana State University — Dept. of Teaching & Learning • Terre Haute, IN

- Served as teaching assistant for undergraduate courses, supporting instruction and student learning
- Conducted qualitative research on learner engagement and access to drive evidence-based instructional decisions
- Delivered the department's portion of Indiana State's university-wide Blackboard-to-Canvas LMS migration — converted and tested course shells in the new environment, then resolved post-cutover issues for faculty

Graduate Assistant

Aug 2021 – Jul 2023

Office of the President & Provost, Indiana State University • Terre Haute, IN

- Created comprehensive training manual and social media guidelines for university managers
- Developed interactive SoftChalk learning modules for the university's Online Teaching Certificate program
- Managed university communications including ISU Today announcements and calendar publishing

Curriculum Developer

Dec 2020 – Aug 2021

Hands In Outreach (HIO) • Sheffield, MA

- Designed a 3-year adult literacy curriculum serving 150+ women in Nepal, progressing from foundational literacy to digital skills

- Created Career Days program connecting high school girls to education and career pathways (50+ participants)
- Built community-based delivery models aligned with local capacity and sustainability goals

Graduate Assistant Sep 2019 – Dec 2020
Office of Education Abroad, Center for Global Engagement, Indiana State University • Terre Haute, IN

- Delivered pre-departure and new-student orientation programming for study-abroad and international exchange students; supported the Peer Advisor program and maintained student records across Banner and Talisma/CRM

Computer Science Teacher, Curriculum Designer & Education Technologist Apr 2014 – Nov 2018
Lalitpur Secondary Boarding School • Lalitpur, Nepal

- Designed and taught the Grades 5–6 computer science curriculum, and launched the school's after-school Junior Coding Club — introducing Scratch and growing enrolment from 5 to 30
- Introduced classroom technology new to the school; ran a recurring faculty training program on using video and visual media in lesson planning
- Founded the annual IT & Communication Fair — the first in the region, and it outlasted my tenure — and co-coordinated Lalitpur's first Students Quality Circle Convention

EDUCATION

May 2026 PhD in Curriculum & Instruction Indiana State University	Dec 2020 MS in Educational Technology Indiana State University	Sep 2017 BSc Hons in Computing (IT) London Metropolitan University
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SKILLS

Instructional Design: ADDIE, SAM, Backward Design, UDL, Needs Assessment, Kirkpatrick Evaluation, Competency Frameworks, Microlearning, Storyboarding	Learning Platforms & Authoring: Canvas LMS, Blackboard, SCORM, Articulate 360 (Storyline, Rise), SoftChalk, Adobe Captivate, Camtasia
AI & Development: AI Literacy & Enablement, Claude Code, LLM Integration, Prompt Engineering, HTML/CSS/JavaScript, Python, SQL, Git/GitHub, Accessibility (WCAG, ARIA)	Leadership: Program Management, Stakeholder Alignment, Instructor Enablement, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Data-Driven Iteration

SELECTED PROJECTS

Zero to Live: Building with Claude Code — Built an 11-page portfolio using an AI agent, then documented the process as a free interactive course with progress tracking and interactive checklists. 48 repo clones in the first week.

AI Decoded: An AI/ML Crash Course — Designed and built a 6-lesson interactive course teaching AI fundamentals to curious professionals, with knowledge checks and completion gating.

PUBLICATIONS

Sitaula, A. (2026). *The Experience of South Asian International Students in Online Classes* [Doctoral dissertation, Indiana State University]. ProQuest.

Sitaula, A. (2024). "The Kaleidoscope of Connections." In *Bridging Cultures, Empowering Futures* (pp. 15-18). STAR Scholar Press.

Sitaula, A., & Sitaula, G. (2021). "Lap of Mount Everest Our Lab of Learning." In *World of Children* (pp. 181-202). Linton Atlantic Books.